

Zihao Gong, PhD

Assistant Research Fellow | Male | China
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Education

University of Liverpool (China Campus), PhD in Finance Oct 2015 – Sep 2022
Research fields: Risk Measurement; Machine Learning-Based Dynamic Hedging and Risk Forecasting.
Dissertation: *Risk Management in the Crude Oil Market*; Supervisors: Michael Chng, Jari Kappi, Gareth Liu-Evans

London School of Economics and Political Science, MSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics Sep 2013 – Aug 2014
Supervisor: Mohan Bijapur

University of Liverpool, BSc in Economics Sep 2009 – Jun 2013
First Class Honours

Publications

- [1] **Zihao Gong**, Wenli Huang, and Xinfeng Ruan. *A Convolutional-Based Heterogeneous Autoregressive Model for Implied Volatility Surface Forecasting*. *The Journal of Derivatives*, 2026, 33(3): 46–73.
(A-class journal at Zhejiang University; ABS 2; ABDC A)

Working Papers

- [1] **Zihao Gong**, You Yu, Shuai Zhang, and Wenli Huang. *Systemic Contagion in the Cryptocurrency Market*, submitted to *International Review of Economics and Finance*.
- [2] **Zihao Gong**, Jari Kappi, and Michael Chng. *Jumping for CAViaR: Price Jump and Conditional Tail Risk*, target journal: *Journal of Futures Markets*.
- [3] Michael Chng, **Zihao Gong**, and Jari Kappi. *Error in Aggregating Futures Return*, target journal: *Critical Finance Review*.
- [4] Michael Chng, **Zihao Gong**, and Jari Kappi. *State-dependent Hedging*.

Conference Presentations

- [1] Derivatives Markets Conference, Queenstown, New Zealand, 2025.
- [2] 9th China Youth Derivatives Forum, Hangzhou, China, 2025.
- [3] 14th Annual Conference on Financial Engineering and Financial Risk Management of the Operations Research Society of China, Haining, China, 2025.
- [4] 23rd China Annual Conference on Financial Engineering, Chongqing, China, 2024.

Research Projects

Government-Funded Projects

- [1] National Natural Science Foundation of China (2026–2029), *Corporate Dynamic Multi-layer Networks and Stock Market Stability: Impact and Transmission Mechanisms* (PI: Wenli Huang), ongoing, participant.
- [2] Key Project of the Provincial Soft Science Research Program (2025–), *Research on the Multi-Dimensional Collaborative Mechanism and Optimization Strategies of Sci-Tech Finance Policies*, ongoing, participant.
- [3] Provincial Graduate Education Reform Project during the 14th Five-Year Plan (2024–), *Research on Innovative Training Models for FinTech Graduate Students from an Interdisciplinary Integration Perspective*, ongoing, participant.

Industry-Commissioned Projects

- [1] Decision-Making Consulting Project of Xiaoshan District, *Policy Recommendations for Optimizing the Operation of State-Owned Industrial Funds in Xiaoshan District from a High-Quality Development Perspective*, completed, participant.
- [2] Financial 15th Five-Year Plan Project of Jindong District, Jinhua, ongoing, participant.

Policy Report

- [1] Huang Wenli, **Zihao Gong**, and Yong Chen (2025). *Dollar Storm: Global Repercussions of the Trump Administration's Assault on Federal Reserve Independence and China's Response*. Adopted by a national-level government body, the Office of the Central National Security Commission.

Teaching Experience

Zhejiang University of Finance & Economics, Research Fellow Dec 2023 – Mar 2026

Conducted interdisciplinary research in asset pricing, corporate finance, risk management, machine learning, and large language models; contributed to the design and teaching of factor investing courses; supervised undergraduate and postgraduate thesis writing.

Postdoctoral Supervisor: Wenli Huang

Lecturer (Part-Time, Bilingual), Xianda College of Economics and Humanities, Shanghai International Studies University Sep 2020 – Feb 2021

Taught *Microeconomics* in Chinese and *Financial Markets* in English; supervised undergraduate dissertations.

Teaching Assistant, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University Sep 2015 – Jun 2019

Courses: *Mathematical Economics*, *Business Economics*, *Corporate Finance*, *Securities Markets*, and *Advanced Corporate Finance*.

Honours and Impact

- [1] Outstanding Supervisor, The 3rd China Graduate Financial Technology Innovation Competition, 2024. Co-supervised a postgraduate team with Professor Wenli Huang on the project *Harmony of Credit Information: A Cross-Institution Credit Risk Assessment System Based on Federated Learning and Multi-Dimensional Relational Data Analysis*, which won the national first prize.
- [2] Undergraduate entrepreneurship mentoring: contributed to the establishment of Hangzhou Lanqi Technology Co., Ltd. The company provides AI-driven data services for financial institutions, including data analytics, industry research, and intelligent report generation, and received government support from Yuhang District.

Industry Experience

KBG Fund, Financial Market Analyst Aug 2014 – Sep 2015

Conducted investment return analysis and financial modeling; evaluated the investment value of REIT projects; analyzed the feasibility of equity crowdfunding projects.

Kunshan Rural Commercial Bank, Assistant in Credit Risk Analysis Mar 2016 – Aug 2016

Analyzed credit risk in local government financing vehicle bonds; prepared thematic macroeconomic reports; participated in personal credit scoring model development and risk assessment.

Skills

Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

Software: Proficient in Python, R, LaTeX, Codex, and OpenClaw; experienced in data analysis and modeling; familiar with machine learning, deep learning, and large language models; familiar with databases including CSMAR, Wind, and WRDS.